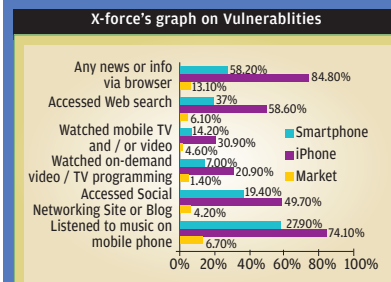


STAT ATTACK



In the US, broadband mobile Internet connections jumped to 2.16 million in the final three months of 2007 as compared to 854,000 in the same period last year, according to comScore

Gartner predicts 11 per cent rise in worldwide PC shipments compared to 2007 at 293 million units in 2008 due to emerging markets

According to a study by MultiMedia Intelligence, 50 per cent of all phones shipped worldwide will be music-capable by 2011

IDC says there is about 281 billion GBs (281 exabytes; or 45 GB per person) on earth in the 'digital universe'

measures, including relocating servers where the sites are present to Indian territory.

According to statistics released by the government, the past few months have seen a rash of attacks against Web sites of bodies like the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India, Indian Railways, Department of Telecom, Air Cargo Customs and National Institute of Social Defence. These attackers used several tactics to compromise the sites. Phishing seemed to be a hot favourite, followed by

unauthorized scanning and virus injection. Defacing was also one of the most used tactics with attackers defacing the Web site of even the Department of Information Technology, the nodal body which is in charge of cyber security. Talk about guarding the guards.

The Home Ministry has sounded out the alert after these hacking incidents and has suggested that all government sites be hosted on Central or State government servers. This is because most if the affected sites have been hosted

offshore on privately owned servers. That means that these servers, hosting sensitive information sometimes related to national security are not within the jurisdiction of Indian authorities. The MHA wants all the sites moved to servers hosted by the National Informatics Centre (NIC) or Education and Research Network (ERNET). To prevent these attacks from occurring again, a DIT body, the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-IN), is installing tools like a network flow based threat assessment solution and attack detection system. Additionally it has drafted a set of guidelines involving issues related to network security and architecture, firewalls, intrusion detection systems, secure coding practices, etc., for securing Web sites in the future.

LET'S PLAY ENGLISH

Word Me Perfect

People are already obsessed with social networking and instant messaging. Aren't they? Whether at college or work, these both remain the headaches of IT departments. Recent obsession is Scrabulous—the word game which has hit the systems of several users. The cyborgs of this viral fever spread through social networking site Facebook's

group and now Scrabulous has become the top pass-time activity of millions.

Scrabulous, a popular Facebook app, was pleaded to shutdown because the toy maker giant Hasbro found it very similar to their board game *Scrabble*. Due to its similarity, the app was already popular and this piece news triggered the traffic on Facebook.

People looked upon Hasbro's allegations as a jealous stupid kid. Hasbro sent notice to Facebook to shutdown and remove the app. The users even warned of going on hunger strike if Facebook removed Scrabulous from apps after Hasbro's demands. To save it, they even started a group—*Save Scrabulous*. Made by two Indian brothers for sake of fun, today the site has over 700,000 users bringing the owners about \$25,000 per month as advertising revenue.

Being an online game and several users across the globe to compete with adds tinge of excitement and also creates a social platform. Though some players are involved in cheating (yeah, even in this game), there's nothing much to w00t about except personal glory.

Playing Scrabulous may help vocabulary developments but also wastes thousands of man hours if played at office.

The makers of Scrabble believe that the online version can and will affect their sales. While on the other hand, several instances cropped up about



Quick Path

What is it?

Quick Path, also known as Common System Interface is a point-to-point processor interconnect which is intended to replace the Front Side Bus used in traditional processor architecture. It has high bandwidth and extremely low latencies. Like TCP/IP it is a combination of five layers: physical, link, routing, transport and protocol (in ascending order). Each of these layers have different responsibilities and some of them may be omitted in less complex systems.

Who is developing it?

Intel is developing this technology as a rival to HyperTransport, another point-to-point interface used for long by many manufacturers in chipsets, routers, processors and servers.

Why is it needed?

With the dominance of multi-core systems the need for faster data transfers between different cores are needed so that performance is not bottlenecked. In particular, processors with four or more cores need more bandwidth than the FSB can handle.

When is it going to debut?

Quick Path is going to debut in the second half of 2008.

Where will it be implemented?

It is going to be implemented on Xeon and Itanium platforms and will be first used by Nehalem and Tukwila processors. Quick Path is highly scalable and is designed for laptops as well as server farms.

How will performance change?

With 4.8 to 6.4 Gigatransfers per second and bus widths of up to 20 bits, the theoretical bandwidth is 24–32 Gbps per bus. These high speeds are needed in mission critical applications and eventually be faster than HyperTransport machines technology.



people who purchased the board game after playing it online. Slowly realising the online potential, Hasbro announced that it would come up with an online version of Scrabble with Electronic Arts soon. Seems to us that Hasbro changed its tune pretty quick when it saw a potential business opportunity.

SMART VISION

TV View

It has finally happened. All this while—since the time John Logie Baird invented television—it has been one-way traffic. People watch TV. They do have the option to change channels or even switch the tube off. But they can't do anything apart from that. Now Comcast is in the process of testing new technologies which it hopes will take care of the common 'there-is-nothing-good-on-the-TV-today' complaint.

In an informal talk a senior Comcast executive (the firm is also a big ISP in North America) has mooted using cameras in set top boxes. These cameras would use smart technology to recognize who is sitting on the couch based on body forms. There is no face recognition feature suggested as of now, which means that people don't need to have a picture of their face in the system. It will be used to provide contextual advertisements, as well as shows based on past preferences. Also, if a

family is watching a show and there are any inappropriate scenes that require parental controls the system will automatically censor them.

This system, however, has plenty of scope for misuse. Many people won't necessarily want a camera looking into their living rooms, which would easily be construed as invasion of privacy. Combine this with the fact that Comcast has a history of unscrupulous business tactics like surreptitiously blocking selected traffic like torrent downloads, and we are pretty sure this will get the thumbs down. That said, under proper regulations and monitoring by a responsible body, this system could be a pretty useful tool, especially when parents worry about kids watching FTV on the sly.

GOOGLE LENDS A HAND

Eradicate Polio

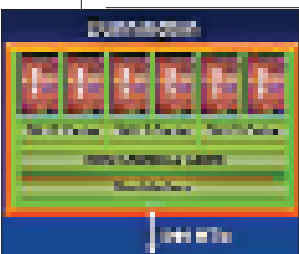
Remember those public service announcements about polio on television? While polio outbreaks were frequent across India, thanks to the electronic media, a wave of awareness about polio eradication had permeated to every corner of the country. Now, to give it a further push, Google Foundation has donated \$3.5 million to Rotary International towards eradicating polio from India and the rest of the world.

Monetary contribution from IT giants like Google, Microsoft and Intel among many others can be termed as part of their Corporate Social Responsibility. For instance, Google has been pushing *green computing* actively for conservation of environment. While this not for profit step by Google Foundation is one of their initiatives besides the investments in development of SME sector that will help India.

Deepak Kapur, Chairman of the India National PolioPlus Committee of Rotary, said, "The polio battle in India today is just short of the finishing line, and the much needed funds supported by **Google.org** will further boost the campaign in India and the world to eradicate polio forever." Like India, three other polio-endemic countries—Pakistan, Afghanistan and Nigeria will benefit from this funding.

Rotary's philanthropy aims to reach most challenging destinations on earth. As part of this initiative, India has received Rs 3.12 billion grant so far. India has had the most polio outbreaks with about 60 per cent of the global polio cases. In 2007, 844 polio cases were recorded as compared to 676 in the previous year.

But from them any innovative way to raise funds would be something really appreciative. For instance, it would be nice to see if Google came out with any innovative 'Help for Polio eradication' campaigns. Like signing up for using Google's online services where Google will pay the beneficiaries certain share depending upon usage. That would be totally different than mere clicking on Ads and banners. While the drive to eradicate polio from India is about to conclude, this push will help it to finish it earlier. ■



Dunnington

Move over quad cores, here's the new hexacore processor from Intel to steal your thunder. Intel has announced that it will be launching a native six core processor named Dunnington based on the Penryn architecture later this year. Although aimed at servers, we suspect that the migration to desktops and maybe even laptops won't take long.

According to the technical specifications, Dunnington uses a 45-nm die fabrication process. The six cores between them share three 3M L2 caches and a 16-MB Shared L3 cache. It also implements Quick

Path interconnects, an Intel patented point-to-point data transfer interface replacing the traditional slower Front Side Bus. Data transfer rates would be 25.6 Gbps. It also has an integrated memory controller and supports DDR3-800 memory.

Simultaneous multithreading (SMT) is another feature that is widely touted. SMT enables each core to handle two threads at a time—speeds will see a huge increase. Implementation of this feature in Dunnington means that servers will be able to handle more requests and speed up delivery of pages.

Buzzword of the MONTH